Alexander Leonard

AI Enablement and Operations Associate

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Professional summary

Operations professional transitioning into AI enablement, with experience supporting safe, efficient industrial workflows and current study in AI Engineering. Built Merlin, a mitochondrial DNA research project using a structured six-path methodology. Contributed a C bug fix to the GNU Emacs syntax engine. Brings practical AI and programming interest, equipment operations experience, and a focus on responsible process improvement.

Work experience

Open Source Contributor — GNU Emacs
August 2026

- Diagnosed a fatal assertion failure (SINGLE_BYTE_CHAR_P) in the Emacs syntax engine: calling syntax-class with a multibyte character while the current buffer was unibyte aborted the editor.
- Traced the crash path through package.el and org-mode's syntax-table handling; filed upstream bug #81723 with a minimal reproducer.
- Wrote a C patch for src/syntax.c (char-syntax) that resolves multibyte characters through their syntax descriptor before any single-byte table lookup; shipped as a fix package with an elisp-level workaround and usage docs.
- Reported a related input-delay issue with elisp-fontify-semantically, including CPU and memory profiler data.

Front Wheel Loader Operator
Ready Mix USA
2023 to Present

- Operated front wheel loaders and forklifts in a fast-paced industrial environment.
- Followed safety procedures while handling materials and supporting daily operations.
- Coordinated with team members to maintain efficient material flow and workflow continuity.
- Used mechanical aptitude and equipment knowledge to support reliable operations.

Independent Research Project Developer
Merlin

- Developed Merlin, a mitochondrial DNA research project using a six-path methodology.
- Organized research questions and analysis stages into a repeatable study framework.

- Applied structured workflows to support systematic interpretation of research findings.
- Documented project work in a GitHub portfolio for review and continued development.

Education

General Educational Development

Licenses

Driver’s License

Skills

AI systems, AI governance, Process improvement, Workflow design, Heavy equipment operation, Programming (C, Python), Data analysis, Forklift operation, Operations, OSHA safety